

Threats against your online presence

If you're sure that you didn't change your password or make a typing mistake and yet Gmail says that your password was recently changed, your account is no longer yours. This, however, is not the only way by which you could lose control of your online presence.

Facebook is not all rainbows and butterflies

If an unknown app for your computer can be a virus, a Facebook app can also be one. In this case, it won't disturb your computer but your online presence. These apps can be built by anyone and be hosted anywhere. Though they're part of Facebook's ecosystem, the social network doesn't take any responsibility for their activities. You do! Depending on what permissions you have given to a Facebook app, it can read your posts, post on your friends' walls on your behalf, read your profile information, your friends' profile information and store it on a different server. That can be a serious threat to you as well as your online friends. Before giving permissions to any app, ask yourself two questions:

1. Do I need this app?
2. Do I trust the creator of this app?

If you say no to either one, do not authorize an app. Even if you have to, carefully read what permissions you're granting the app. Similar rules apply for third-party Twitter apps.

Passwords – change them regularly for Lee's sake

Ever since Tim Berners Lee invented the web, email and then webmail has been one of the biggest revolutions in business and communication. If anyone were to gain access to your email account and send out unwanted emails, you would have to take the heat. You wouldn't even have evidence of the sent mail in your outbox and your relationships might sour before you know it.

Gmail allows you to see your other "active sessions" with locations from where the account was accessed. If you see any suspicious activity, log out of all other sessions and change your password immediately. One of the changes that an unauthorized accessor of your account would do is change the answer to your security question. It's a wise idea to check if the 'forgot password' feature works.

Your personal data is worth money

We're sure many geeks would have had this question asked of them: "Could